

DINGWEI GUO

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EDUCATION

University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill Ph.D. in Economics Committee: Donna Gilleskie (chair), Luca Flabbi, Désiré Kédagni, Klara Peter, Sean Sylvia	2022 - 2027 (expected)
University of Wisconsin–Madison M.S. in Economics	2021 - 2022
Xi'an Jiaotong University B.A. in Economics	2017 - 2021

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Labor Economics, Development Economics, Energy and Environment Economics

RESEARCH

Job market paper

Unburdened Fields, Mobilized Workers: Labor Market Responses to Agricultural Tax Reform and Intergenerational Consequences

In many developing economies, the coexistence of low productivity agriculture and surplus labor in farming reflects a fundamental sectoral misallocation that slows structural transformation and limits long run growth. This paper studies how the agricultural tax reform in China between 2000 and 2006 reshaped this distorted equilibrium. First, by employing a staggered difference-in-differences (DID) design, I document a large and immediate financial benefits from tax reform on rural families. I argue that rural households responded by investing heavily in agricultural machinery, which substituted for manual labor and reduced labor input in farm sectors. These adjustments facilitated labor reallocation into higher-productivity non-farm employment. Second, I employ a cohort DID specification to study intergenerational impacts. I show the exposure to tax reform at school ages significantly raised the educational attainments of teenagers and generated more long-run benefits in their adulthood, suggesting a persistent gain in human capital accumulation and labor allocation adjustment. Finally, I show these micro-level changes are different between genders and are concentrated on females and girls. The results highlight how fiscal reforms that relax production constraints can trigger technology adoption, mitigate labor misallocation, and generate persistent improvements in human capital formation.

Other work

Development policy evaluation

- Dingwei Guo, Yuan Zhao, and Kaixi He. “Beyond the Farm: How Agricultural Cooperatives Reshape Rural Labor Allocation and Income.” *Under review*. [Latest Version](#)
- Dingwei Guo, Yuan Zhao, and Xiyan Li. “Leave or stay: inequality of the poverty alleviation resettlement program.” *Journal of Development Effectiveness* (2026): 1-25. [Journal](#) [Unedited Version](#) [Appendix](#)
- Jie Feng, Yuan Zhao, Kaixi He, and Dingwei Guo. “Beyond Targets: Spatial Spillovers of Targeted Poor County Program.” *Under review*.

- Hanchen Li, Yuan Zhao, Ruting Huang, Xiyan Li, and Dingwei Guo. “Give a Man a Fish? Passive Income versus Livelihood Support for Persistent Poverty Alleviation.” *Working in Progress*.

Experiment and valuation of non-market good in energy and environment

- Yuan Zhao and Dingwei Guo. “When Money Crowds Out Morals: A Study of Demand-Side Management Participation.” *Under review*.
- Dingwei Guo, Yuan Zhao, and Zhi Li. “Eliciting Willingness to Pay from Alternative Contingent Valuation Formats: An Application to a Large-Scale Water Diversion Project.” *Accepted at Environment and Development Economics*. [Latest Version](#)
- Yuan Zhao, Weihua Yu, Dingwei Guo, and Xiaoping He. “Household Customers’ Cost of Interruption: Survey Study on Summer Electricity Peak of Xi’an City.” *Frontiers in Energy Research* 9 (2022): 802018. [Journal](#)

Intra-household decision

- Zining Li, Yuan Zhao, and Dingwei Guo. “Who Earns, Who Bears: Relative Income, Bargaining Power, and Fertility Decisions.” *R&R*. [Latest Version](#)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant

- Introduction to Economics (Econ 101): Fall 2023, Fall 2024, Spring 2026
- Introduction to Data Science and Econometrics (Econ 400): Spring 2025
- Intermediate Microeconomics (Econ 410): Spring 2024, Fall 2026
- Analysis of Public Finance (Econ 440): Fall 2025

GRANT & AWARD

- Best Research Award in Applied Micro (UNC): 2026
- Graduate Assistantship (UNC): 2022 - 2027

SKILLS

Programming	Python, Stata, SQL
Language	Chinese (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Donna Gilleskie

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Department of Economics
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Luca Flabbi

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Sean Sylvia

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